

INDIA'S COLLEGES THE INDIA TODAY-NIELSEN SURVEY

may grumble about their placement in the ranks. And the hundreds of colleges surveyed which don't figure at all in the toppers' list may feel dismayed, even dispirited. They need not be. With over 17,000 colleges apart from 109 universities and another 300-odd deemed ones, the competition for the top slots in the country remains intense. But what the 13 years of evaluation of academic performance has shown is that those colleges which constantly innovate, remain contemporary, focus on hiring and retaining the best faculty and are willing to spend generously to improve facilities for students are the ones that regularly figure in the toppers' list.

The formula for greatness is apparent. But for aspirants the key remains application. The results of the 2009 INDIA TODAY-Nielsen Survey have shown why this is true. Shri Ram College of Commerce (SRCC), Delhi, has the rare distinction of being numero uno in its stream ever since the INDIA TODAY surveys began and has retained the top slot among commerce colleges this year too. Yet the college refuses to rest on its laurels. As SRCC's principal P.C. Jain says, "The college reinvents itself to ensure that it keeps pace with the rapid changes sweeping through business education."

Loyola College, Chennai, which straddles two major streams—arts and science—like a Colossus, works hard to retain its edge. It may be 84 years old and steeped in tradition but the reason why it is No. 1 is because it strives to remain contemporary and relevant. "We focus on getting our students involved with the community around us and on issues that bother the common man," says Loyola's principal Rev. Dr. A. Albert Muthumalai. The All India Institute of Medical Science (AIIMS), which comes first in the medicine stream for the seventh consecutive year, has its own mantra. It has remained ahead of the pack because, as its director, Ramesh Chandra Deka, points out, "It has focused on being a leader in healthcare and globally competitive research."

The toppers of the two other

13 YEAR TOPPERS

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	Loyola College, Chennai	LSR, Delhi	St. Stephen's College, Delhi
2008	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi
2007	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	LSR, Delhi
2006	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Presidency College, Kolkata	Loyola College, Chennai
2005	LSR, Delhi	Presidency College, Chennai	Loyola College, Chennai
2004	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
2003	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	LSR, Delhi
2002	Presidency College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	Madras Christian College, Chennai
2001	Presidency College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	LSR, Delhi
2000	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Loyola College, Chennai	Presidency College, Chennai
1999	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
1998	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
1997	Colleges were not ranked across streams. Best overall colleges were St. Stephen's College, Delhi, Presidency College, Kolkata, and LSR, Delhi.		

ARTS

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	Loyola College, Chennai
2008	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
2007	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	LSR, Delhi	Loyola College, Chennai
2006	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Loyola College, Chennai
2005	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	BM College of Commerce, Pune
2004	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	Presidency College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
2003	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
2002	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
2001	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	Presidency College, Chennai
2000	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Presidency College, Chennai
1999	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
1998	Shri Ram College of Commerce, Delhi	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Joseph's (Com), Bangalore
1997	No ranking done.		

COMMERCE

YEARS	1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
2009	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata
2008	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata
2007	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Ahmedabad
2006	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Presidency College, Chennai
2005	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata
2004	Presidency College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Kolkata	Loyola College, Chennai
2003	Madras Christian College, Chennai	Presidency College, Kolkata	Presidency College, Chennai
2002	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai	Presidency College, Kolkata
2001	Presidency College, Chennai	Loyola College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi
2000	Presidency College, Chennai	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
1999	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
1998	St. Stephen's College, Delhi	Presidency College, Kolkata	St. Xavier's College, Mumbai
1997	No ranking done.		

SCIENCE